91. Which one of the following pairs of countries joined the European Union in January, 2007?

(a) Bulgaria and Romania
(b) Bulgaria and Belgium
(c) Romania and Slovenia
(d) Hungary and Croatia

Ans. (a) : Bulgaria and Romania joined European Union in January 2007.

92. Raghu Rai is well-known for which one of the following areas?

(a) Research in Mathematics
(b) Photography
(c) Water harvesting
(d) Pollution control

Ans. (b) : Raghu Rai is an Indian photographer and photojournalist.

93. Who among the following is Chile's first woman President?

(a) D. Ortega (b) M. Bachelet
(c) E. Morales (d) A. Garcia

Ans. (b) : Michelle Bachelet was the first female president of Chile from 2006 to 2014. In December 2013, Bachelet was re-elected as President of Chile with over 62% of the vote. She is the first person since 1932 to win the presidency of Chile twice in competitive elections.

94. What was the purpose of the Operation Sukoon launched by the Government of India?

(a) Helping Indonesia in its efforts to rehabilitate the victims of earthquake in the country.
(b) Evacuating the Indian Nationals from Lebanon during the conflict in the Middle East.
(c) Assisting United Nations in its efforts to help the civil war victims in the Darfur region of North Africa.
(d) Providing a relief package to farmers after a spate of suicides by other farmers in Andhra Pradesh.

Ans. (b) : Operation Sukoon was an operation launched by the Indian Navy to evacuate Indian, Sri Lankan and Nepalese nationals, as well as Lebanese nationals with Indian spouses, from the conflict zone during the 2006 Lebanon War.

95. Which one of the following countries recently upgraded its defence agency to a full defence ministry?

(a) Italy (b) Japan
(c) Switzerland (d) Poland

Ans. (b) : For the first time since World War II, Japan upgraded its Defence Agency to a full ministry in 2007. The upgrade of the Defence Agency, formerly under the Cabinet Office, was propelled by deep concern in Japan over the development of North Korean missiles and nuclear weapons.

96. Consider the following statements:

1. China has the observer's status at the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation.
2. India has the observer's status at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation.

Which of the statements give above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : States with observer status in South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) include Australia, China, the European Union, Iran, Japan, Mauritius, Myanmar, South Korea and the United States. India has observer status in the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO), India and Pakistan became its permanent member in 2017.

97. In the latter half of the year 2006, in which one of the following countries did a military coup take place?

(a) Cambodia (b) Laos
(c) Thailand (d) Vietnam

Ans. (c) : The Thai military launched a coup against Prime Minister Thaksin Shinawatra in September 2006, declaring martial law throughout Thailand. The military also announced the formation of an interim regime, as indicated by Lieutenant General Sonthi Boonyaratglin, the commander-in-chief of the army.

98. Which one of the following is not a member of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation?

(a) Russia (b) Kazakhstan
(c) Ukraine (d) Uzbekistan

Ans. (c) : The Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) currently comprises eight member States - China, India, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Pakistan, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan.

99. Who among the following wrote the book Ayodhya : 6 December 1992?

(a) Chandra Shekhar (b) PV. Narasimha Rao
(c) Jaswant Singh (d) Arun Shourie

Ans. (b) : In the book Ayodhya, the author PV Narasimha Rao has explained the Ayodhya issue with a political perspective. Pamulaparti Venkata Narasimha Rao (28 June 1921 – 23 December 2004) was an Indian lawyer and politician who served as the tenth Prime Minister of India (1991–1996).

100. With reference to the international meetings held in the year 2006, which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. NAM Summit : Havana
2. APEC Meeting : Bangkok
3. EU-India Summit : Helsinki
4. UN Climate Change Conference : Geneva

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b) : The 14th NAM Summit was held on 16 September 2006 in Havana (Cuba). The 17th EU India Summit took place in Helsinki on 13 October 2006. The 14th APEC Summit took place in Hanoi on 18-19 November 2006 (Vietnam). The United Nations Climate Change Conference 2006 took place in Nairobi, Kenya, between 6 and 17 November 2006.

101. The Stilwell Road, built in 1940's, which was recently in news, connects which of the following?

(a) Agartala in India and Yangon in Myanmar via Bangladesh.
(b) Ledo in India and Kumming in China via Myanmar.
(c) Kalimpong in India and Lhasa in Tibet via Bhutan.
(d) Imphal in India and Bangkok in Thailand via Myanmar.

Ans. (b) : The Stilwell Road built in 1940s by Americans to connect Ledo in India and Kunming in China via Myanmar during Second World War.

102. MCA-21 is a major initiative taken up by the Government of India in which one of the following areas?

(a) Foreign direct investment in India.
(b) Attracting international tourists.
(c) e-governance.
(d) Modernization of airports.

Ans. (c) :
1: This is related to the e-filing of taxes by the companies in India.
2: MCA21 is an e-Governance initiative of the Ministry of Company Affairs (MCA), Government of India that enables easy and secure access of the MCA services to the corporate entities, professionals and citizens of India.

103. Near the end of the year 2006, which one of the following countries was suspended from the Commonwealth after a military coup?

(a) Kenya (b) Myanmar
(c) Fiji (d) Tanzania

Ans. (c) : In December 2006, the Commonwealth suspended Fiji in protest against the military coup. Fiji's military commander, Commodore Frank Bainimarama announced that he had taken control of the country against the Prime Minister, Laisenia Qarase.
It is for the third time in 20 years that the Pacific nation has been suspended from Commonwealth of Nations because of military coup.

104. Consider the following statements:

1. The nation-wide scheme of the National Child Labour Projects (NCLP) is run by the Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.
2. Gurupadswamy Committee dealt with the issues of child labour.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : National Child Labour Projects (NCLF) is run by the Union Ministry of Labour and Employment. In 1979, Government formed the first committee called Gurupadswamy Committee to study the issue of child labour and to suggest measures to tackle it. Hence only statement 2 is correct.

105. Which of the following countries signed the Tshwane Declaration in October, 2006?

(a) China and South Africa.
(b) India and South Africa.
(c) South Africa and Botswana.
(d) Saudi Arabia and South Africa.

Ans. (b) : The Tshwane Declaration was signed by India and South Africa in 2006. Through this declaration both the parties reaffirmed their Strategic Partnership.

106. Recently, the European Union and other six countries including India signed the International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor (ITER) Project. Which one of the following was not a signatory to it?

(a) Canada (b) China
(c) Japan (d) USA

Ans. (a) : India, European Union, along with 5 other nations (China, Japan, Korea, Russia and United States) signed the ITER Project. Canada was not among the signatories as it stayed out of the agreement due to scarcity of necessary resources.

107. Which one of the following Himalayan Passes was reopened around in the middle of the year 2006 to facilitate trade between Indian and China?

(a) Chang La (b) Jara La
(c) Nathu La (d) Shipki La

Ans. (c) : Nathu La Himalayan Passes was reopened around in the middle of the year 2006 to facilitate trade between India and China.